Automating Office Documents with Python

Office workers spend many hours every week copying text between PDF files and Word documents. Python can automate this kind of repetitive document work with a few well-known libraries.

PyPDF2 reads PDF files page by page. It can extract text, merge several files into one, split a large file into smaller parts and rotate pages.

python-docx creates and edits Word documents. It supports headings, paragraphs with bold or italic text, tables with styles and pictures.

Challenges and Best Practices

Text extraction depends on how the PDF was created. Scanned PDFs contain images instead of text and need OCR tools such as Tesseract.

Always check that input files exist, handle exceptions for corrupted files, and keep generated documents in a separate output folder.